# TECHNICAL COMMUNICATION

Faculty of Automatic Control and Computer Science
Lecturer Simona Mazilu, PhD

# DELIVERING AN ORAL PRESENTATION

DELIVERY: verbal (content & rhetorical techniques) + paraverbal (tone of voice) + nonverbal communication (body language) > PREPARING + PRACTISING

**I. VOICE:** sound + silence

**I.1 SOUND**:

- **intensity**: How loud
- **inflection** (intonation): flat/varied
- **rate**: How fast
- **frequency**: pitch
- **quality**: rough/smooth

• Alex Lyon on tone of voice (8.06 min) https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=5hvVjOqk_4o

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**I.2 SILENCE** (pausing)

Types of pauses: sense, emphatic, dramatic, sentence-completion

- Gerry Spence's final plea (4.36 min): https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=e-Reemd6FzM
- Colonel Slade's speech in *Scent of a Woman* (1992) (5.40 min): https://www.americanrhetoric.com/MovieSpeeches/specialengagements/moviespeechscentofawoman.html

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**II. BODY LANGUAGE**

- eye contact
- facial expressions: 7 universal expressions (anger, happiness, sadness, surprise, fear, disgust, contempt)
- posture
- gestures

• Alex Lyon on body language in presentations (4.51 min)
https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=TmbQFWBvTtY

• Paul Ekman's facial expressions
https://www.paulekman.com/resources/universal-facial-expressions/

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## III. RHETORICAL TECHNIQUES

- 3 main modes of PERSUASION:

1. **Logos** (reason)
2. **Ethos** (character)
3. **Pathos** (emotion)

- **Rhetorical devices**: *antithesis (contrast)*, *rhetorical questions*, *metaphor*, *anaphora*, *parallelism*, *analogy*, *hyperbole*, *repetition*, *inversion* etc.

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- Rhetorical devices (6.56 min)

https://youtu.be/6KUWyEa-ih4

- Obama’ s speech at the Democratic Convention 2004 (6.12 min)

https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=OFPwDe22CoY

- Alex Lyon on how to manage anxiety in public speaking (6.08 min)

https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=VEStYVONy-0

# To do

Prepare a **5-minute** PowerPoint presentation **in pairs** on a technical/scientific subject of your choice integrating all the aspects studied so far within this module and deliver it in front of your colleagues. Your presentation will be structured as follows:
Slide 1: Title of the presentation, authors' names and group
Slide 2: Overview of the presentation
Slide 3: Main point 1
Slide 4: Main point 2
Slide 5: Main point 3
Slide 6: Conclusion
Slide 7: References/Bibliography/Resources

# Resources


- André, C., Lelord, F. (2013). *Cum să ne exprimăm emoţiile şi sentimentele*. Bucureşti: Editura Trei.
- Carnegie, D. (2008). *Cum să vorbim în public*. Bucureşti: Curtea Veche Publishing.
- Corbett, E. P. J. (1971). *Classical Rhetoric for the Modern Student* (2nd edition). New York: Oxford University Press.
- Ekman P. (2011). *Emoţii date pe faţă: cum să citim sentimentele de pe chipul uman*. Bucureşti: Editura Trei.
- Markel, M. (2012). *Technical Communication*. Boston/New York: Bedford/St. Martin's.
- Nuță, A. (2004*). Abilități de comunicare*. București: Editura S.P.E.R.

# Resources


- Pease, A. și Pease, B. (2013). *Abilități de comunicare*. București: Curtea Veche Publishing.
- Pfeiffer, W. S. and Adkins, K. E. (2012). *Technical Communication Fundamentals*. New Jersey: Prentice Hall.
- Powell, M. (2008). *In Company: Upper Intermediate. Student's book.* Macmillan.
- Spence, G. (1995). *How to Argue and Win Every Time*. New York: St. Martin's Press.
- Wilson, G. (2016). *Body Language.* London: Icon Books Ltd.
- https://www.americanrhetoric.com
- https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=p_ylzGfHKOs TEDx Vocal branding